

# Graduation Showcase: Demo Day Lesson Guide

Mastering Storytelling, Public Speaking, and Peer Feedback

## 1. Lesson Overview & Session Objectives

The **Planrs Academy Graduation Showcase (Demo Day)** is a 30-minute celebration designed to highlight student projects, hone essential communication skills, and build self-confidence. Students apply a structured framework to share their learning journeys, present solutions to real-world challenges, and engage in constructive peer evaluation.

### Core Learning Goals:

- **Master Storytelling:** Structure presentations using the *Problem → Idea → Solution → Impact* framework.
- **Public Speaking Confidence:** Apply voice modulation, eye contact, expressive gestures, and strong posture.
- **Glow & Grow Feedback:** Practice giving and receiving kind, actionable, and structured peer feedback.

## 2. The Storytelling Framework

Every effective presentation follows a logical narrative arc. Students structure their 3-minute pitch using four key components:

### 1. Problem

What challenge or obstacle did you discover in your school, home, or community?

### 2. Idea

What creative thought or innovative concept did you develop to address this challenge?

### 3. Solution

How did you build, test, and bring your creative idea to life in a practical way?

### 4. Impact

What real-world change, improvement, or positive benefit did your project create?

## 3. Public Speaking & Delivery Techniques

Delivering an impactful presentation requires combining clear content with confident body language and vocal delivery:



### **Speak Clearly & Pace Yourself**

Speak slowly and articulate words clearly so the entire audience can follow along smoothly. Use intentional pauses to emphasize key ideas.



### **Eye Contact & Warmth**

Look directly at your audience members and smile with confidence. Establishing visual connection keeps listeners engaged and builds trust.



### **Stand Tall & Expressive Gestures**

Maintain a strong, proud posture with shoulders back. Use natural hand gestures to describe ideas and project energy.



### **Voice Modulation & Heart**

Vary your pitch and volume to express enthusiasm, passion, and sincerity throughout your project pitch.

## 4. Constructive Peer Feedback: The "Glow & Grow" Method

Feedback is an essential tool for continuous growth. To create a supportive learning environment, students use the **Glow & Grow** model:

### 🌟 GLOW (Celebration)

Start by sharing a specific element you liked, admired, or found impressive about their presentation, project idea, or delivery style.

*Example: "I loved how clearly you explained the problem and how confident your voice was!"*

### 🌱 GROW (Suggestion)

Offer one kind, helpful, and specific suggestion on how they could improve or make their project even better next time.

*Example: "Next time, you could show a quick diagram of your solution to make it even easier to understand."*

## 5. Indian Innovators & Role Models

To inspire students to dream big and solve real problems, the lesson highlights legendary Indian innovators and modern national initiatives:

- **Dr. A.P.J. Abdul Kalam & Kalpana Chawla:** Demonstrating how big dreams, scientific inquiry, and perseverance can take us beyond the stars.
- **ISRO & Swachh Bharat:** Exemplifying world-class space innovation, teamwork, clean energy, and civic responsibility.
- **UPI & Metro Systems:** Showcasing how technology and smart infrastructure create everyday solutions for millions of citizens.

## 6. Live Demo Day Flow & Facilitator Guide

### Session Agenda (30 Minutes Total)

1. **Welcome & Overview (5 mins):** Setting the stage, reviewing the agenda, and explaining the presentation criteria.
2. **Student Demo Showcase (15 mins):** Each student delivers a 3-minute pitch using the Storytelling Framework, monitored by time cues (Start, Halfway, 30s left).
3. **Mentor Corner & Q&A (5 mins):** 2-minute live Q&A round per presenter featuring open questions and peer Glow & Grow feedback.
4. **Graduation Ceremony & Wrap-Up (5 mins):** Completion announcements, celebrating key highlights, group photo, and encouraging next steps (sharing stories, staying curious).

### Facilitator Quick-Fix Guidelines:

- **Shy Speakers:** Gently invite them with warmth: *"We believe in you! Take a deep breath and share your story."*

- **Time Overruns:** Use a polite, friendly visual signal or smile to help students wrap up smoothly without interrupting their flow.
- **Technical Glitches:** Remain calm, switch seamlessly to manual/verbal presentations, and keep the audience engaged.

# Practice Questions & Reflection

Test your knowledge of storytelling, public speaking, feedback, and innovation

## Section A: Storytelling & Presentation Structure

### QUESTION 1 • MULTIPLE CHOICE

When presenting a project during Demo Day, which sequence represents the correct order of the Planrs Academy Storytelling Framework?

1. Idea → Problem → Impact → Solution
2. Problem → Idea → Solution → Impact
3. Solution → Problem → Idea → Impact
4. Impact → Solution → Idea → Problem

### QUESTION 2 • SHORT ANSWER

Match each project component to its correct description in the framework:

Component A (Problem): \_\_\_\_\_

Component B (Idea): \_\_\_\_\_

Component C (Solution): \_\_\_\_\_

Component D (Impact): \_\_\_\_\_

## Section B: Public Speaking & Delivery

### QUESTION 3 • SCENARIO APPLICATION

Rohan is presenting his science model. He is speaking very fast, looking down at his shoes, and standing completely still without gesturing.

- a. Identify three specific public speaking techniques from the lesson that Rohan should practice to improve his pitch.
- b. Explain how maintaining eye contact and smiling impacts the audience's response.

## Section C: Peer Feedback & Collaboration

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### QUESTION 4 • FEEDBACK EVALUATION

Ananya gave her classmate the following feedback: *"Your project was okay, but you talked too quiet and I didn't like your slides."*

- Why does Ananya's feedback fail to follow the "Glow & Grow" method?
- Rewrite Ananya's feedback using the proper "Glow" (celebrate) and "Grow" (kind suggestion) format.

## Section D: Real-World Innovations & Problem Solving

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### QUESTION 5 • SHORT ESSAY & DESIGN CHALLENGE

Think about a daily issue or challenge in your school (e.g., cafeteria litter, long library queues, or lost water bottles).

- Briefly describe the **Problem** you identified.
- Propose a creative **Idea** to solve it.
- Explain how you would build or implement your **Solution**.
- Describe the positive **Impact** your solution would have on your school community.